B2 Grammar

Conditionals: zero to mixed

All four main conditional patterns plus mixed conditionals, in one table.

Conditionals connect a condition (the *if* clause) with a result. The tense you choose shows how real or likely the situation is.

Type	Form	Use	Example
Zero	if + present, present	General truths	*If you heat ice, it melts.*
First	if + present, will + verb	Real future possibility	*If it rains, we'll stay home.*
Second	if + past, would + verb	Unreal or unlikely present or future	*If I had more time, I'd learn Japanese.*
Third	if + past perfect, would have + past participle	Unreal past	*If I had left earlier, I would have caught the train.*
Mixed	if + past perfect, would + verb	Past condition, present result	*If I had studied medicine, I would be a doctor now.*

Formal style. You can drop *if* and invert: *Had I known, I would have called. Should you need help, ask.*

Common mistake. Never put *would* in the if clause. Say *If I knew*, not *If I would know*.

Practice

1. If she ___ (call) me yesterday, I would have helped.
2. If I ___ (be) you, I'd apologise.
3. If you ___ (press) this button, the machine starts.
4. If he hadn't missed the flight, he ___ (be) here now.
5. Rewrite with inversion: If I had known about the meeting, I would have come.

Teacher page: answers

Print the pages before this one for students.

Answers

1. had called
2. were
3. press
4. would be
5. Had I known about the meeting, I would have come.